THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 03

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

In many Indian villages, the arrival of the monsoon is still greeted like the arrival of a guest of honour. The first drops are welcomed, the soil is smelt, and everyone watches the sky. Yet when the guest departs, very little is kept for later. Most of the rain flows away through drains and rivers to the sea, and by April the same people are standing in queues with empty pots.

Rainwater harvesting is an old answer to this problem. In the deserts of Rajasthan, families built tanks known as tankas under their courtyards and carefully directed the water from their roofs into them. A well-kept tanka could keep a family supplied for months, and no one called it a 'scheme'; it was simply what sensible people did. Over the years, as pipes and pumps arrived, these tanks were forgotten. Taps gave water without effort, and effort was soon forgotten too.

The method is neither costly nor complicated. A rooftop slopes towards a pipe, the pipe leads to a filter of sand and gravel, and the filter ends in a tank or a pit that allows water to seep into the ground. Even a small school building, with a roof of a few hundred square metres, can collect lakhs of litres in a single season. In Rajasthan, where villages once depended on tankas, underground cisterns that kept rainwater for the whole year, the idea is as old as the desert itself. What is new is the urgency: cities that grow without catching their rain must later buy water at a price. Local bodies that make rooftop harvesting compulsory for new buildings, and that provide a small subsidy for old ones, have already seen the water table rise in several localities within a few years.

Today the taps are failing. The level of groundwater has fallen in many places because we draw more than the earth can give back. Wells have gone dry and deeper borewells have to be dug at greater cost. Experts say that the solution is not a single grand project but thousands of small ones: a pit near a house, a pond in a village, a cleaned-up lake in a town.

Young people can lead the change. A school roof that is connected to a storage tank can supply the garden for the whole year. A family can mend leaking taps, which waste several litres a day, and water plants with the water used for washing vegetables. These are small acts, but when a whole neighbourhood repeats them, a river of saving begins to flow.

(i) The writer compares the monsoon to: 1

(a) a guest of honour **(b)** a teacher

(c) a festival **(d)** an enemy

(ii) What is a tanka? 1

(a) A tank built under a courtyard to store rainwater **(b)** A borewell

(c) A kind of pump **(d)** A river

(iii) Why were the old storage tanks forgotten? 1

(a) They were costly **(b)** They were banned

(c) Taps gave water without effort **(d)** They were unsafe

(iv) The fall in groundwater level is caused because we: 1

(a) get too much rain **(b)** draw more than the earth can give back

(c) plant trees **(d)** build tanks

(v) Experts say that the solution is: 1

(a) thousands of small projects **(b)** importing water

(c) closing wells **(d)** one grand project

(vi) What happens to most rainwater in India according to the passage? 1

(vii) Why was a tanka important to a Rajasthan family? 1

(viii) Mention one way a family can save water. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'to send in a particular direction'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'the opposite of arrive'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Years ago, the school's playground used to flood after every shower while its taps ran dry in summer. Following a visit to a nearby village, the students persuaded the management to build a rooftop harvesting system. A rain gauge was placed in the school garden, and the Eco Club has since noted the rainfall every month and measured the water collected in the tank beneath the science block.

The Green Committee of a town measured the monthly rainfall and the quantity of rainwater stored by a school with a harvesting tank in the monsoon months.

Month	Rainfall (mm)	Water stored (thousand litres)
June	120	30
July	320	80
August	280	70
September	180	45

The committee observed that the amount stored followed the amount of rainfall closely, as one would expect. The stored water now irrigates the school garden and flushes the toilets, which has reduced the school's bill for tanker water by almost a third. Impressed by the results, two neighbouring schools have asked for the design of the tank. Next year, the committee plans to add a second tank and a filter so that the water may also be used for drinking after proper testing by the municipal laboratory.

(i) In which month was the rainfall highest? 1

(a) June **(b)** August **(c)** July **(d)** September

(ii) How much water was stored in August? 1

(a) 45 thousand litres **(b)** 30 thousand litres

(c) 80 thousand litres **(d)** 70 thousand litres

(iii) The total water stored in the four months was: 1

(a) 180 thousand litres **(b)** 250 thousand litres

(c) 200 thousand litres **(d)** 225 thousand litres

(iv) How much more rain fell in July than in June? 1

(v) How much water is stored for every 4 mm of rain? 1

(vi) Which month gave the least stored water? 1

(vii) Why would the tank be useful in the dry months? 1

(viii) What is the total rainfall in the four months? 1

(ix) Suggest one use of the stored water in school. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'collecting and keeping'. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND